



A Curated GTA V Modlist & Guide

Game version 1.73 — July 2026

Table of Contents

1.	Getting By	4
1.1.	The Premise	4
1.2.	Franklin Clinton	4
1.3.	Michael De Santa	4
1.4.	Trevor Philips	4
1.5.	This Guide	4
2.	Before You Begin	4
2.1.	Installing OpenIV	4
2.2.	Mod Management with OpenIV	5
2.2.1.	Mods Folder (Recommended)	5
2.2.2.	Direct .rpf Editing	5
2.3.	ScriptHookV	5
2.4.	ASI Mods	5
2.5.	Safety Checklist	5
3.	Wave 0: Modlist	6
3.1.	Mod Entry Format	6
4.	Gameplay Guide	6
4.1.	Core Controls	6
4.2.	Making Money (Early Game)	6
4.2.1.	Story Missions	6
4.2.2.	Stock Market	7
4.2.3.	Side Hustles	7
4.3.	Property Investment	7
4.3.1.	Businesses	7
4.3.2.	Safehouses	7
4.4.	Combat Tips	7
4.5.	Vehicle Tips	7
5.	Untold Stories	9
5.1.	The Premise	9
5.2.	What Changes	9
5.3.	Requirements	9
6.	Migrating from Wave 0	9
6.1.	Backup Your Saves	9
6.2.	Removing Wave 0 Mods	9
6.3.	New Dependencies	9
6.4.	Gameconfig.xml	10
7.	Wave 1: Graphics Mods	10
7.1.	Mod Entry Format	10
8.	Wave 1: Content Mods	10
9.	Wave 1: Mechanics Mods	10
10.	Wave 1: Adult Mods	10
11.	Advanced Strategy Guide	10
11.1.	Optimizing for Modded Gameplay	10
11.1.1.	Memory and Performance	11
11.1.2.	Load Order	11
11.1.3.	Troubleshooting	11
11.2.	Hidden Content Routes	11

Wave 0: Getting By

1. Getting By

1.1. The Premise

You've just arrived in Los Santos and the city doesn't care. Empty pockets, a cheap apartment, and a car that barely runs.

The goal is simple: survive and thrive.

1.2. Franklin Clinton

Franklin sees Los Santos as a ladder. Repo man by day, hustler by night — every job is a step up. For him, “getting by” means escaping the neighborhood that raised him. Learn the streets, build connections, and climb.

Approach: Mission-driven. Follow the main story, invest earnings in properties, build steady income.

1.3. Michael De Santa

Michael has everything and nothing. A mansion, a family that hates him, and a past he can't outrun. “Getting by” for Michael is holding it together — keeping the peace, managing the chaos, and finding purpose beyond the couch and the therapist.

Approach: Side content. Buy the cinema, the cab company, the golf course. Build a legitimate empire while the story pulls him back into crime.

1.4. Trevor Philips

Trevor lives on the fringes. Sandy Shores is his kingdom of misfits, and his version of “getting by” is raw survival — take what you need, burn what you can't carry, and never apologize.

Approach: Explore every corner of Blaine County. Build the Trevor Philips Industries empire through chaos and opportunity.

1.5. This Guide

This wave covers the vanilla GTA V experience with a light layer of quality-of-life mods. You'll learn controls, mechanics, money-making, and how to set up mods safely. Follow the waves in order — Wave 1 assumes you know what's here.

2. Before You Begin

This guide assumes you have GTA V installed and can launch it successfully in single-player.

2.1. Installing OpenIV

OpenIV is the standard mod management tool for GTA V.

1. Download the latest version from openiv.com
2. Run the installer (default settings are fine)
3. Launch OpenIV — it will scan for your GTA V installation automatically

4. Switch OpenIV to **Edit Mode** when prompted (this enables file modification)

Always back up files before editing. OpenIV can create backups automatically — use this feature.

2.2. Mod Management with OpenIV

OpenIV organizes mods through two mechanisms:

2.2.1. Mods Folder (Recommended)

OpenIV's **mods** folder creates a virtual override system:

1. In OpenIV, go to **Tools > Package Installer**
2. Set the install path to your GTA V directory
3. Most mod packages will install into `/mods/` automatically

The **mods** folder keeps the original game files untouched. To disable all mods for GTA Online, rename the **mods** folder to **mods_off**.

2.2.2. Direct .rpf Editing

Some older mods require direct editing of game archives (.rpf files). Only do this if the mod's install guide explicitly requires it. Always back up the original .rpf first.

The most common paths:

- `update/update.rpf` — DLC content, most common target
- `x64/` — Base game textures and models
- `common.rpf` — Shared data and scripts

2.3. ScriptHookV

ScriptHookV is required by almost every mod.

1. Download ScriptHookV (v1.73 compatible version)
2. Extract **ScriptHookV.dll** and **dsound.dll** into your GTA V root folder
3. Download [ScriptHookVDotNet](#) if a mod requires it
4. Extract the .asi and .dll files into the same folder

Verify: Launch the game. If you see the ScriptHookV loading text in the top-left corner, it's working.

2.4. ASI Mods

ASI mods use the OpenIV.asi loader:

- Copy the **.asi** file to your GTA V root folder (**not** the **mods** folder)
- ScriptHookV's **dsound.dll** acts as the ASI loader — no extra steps needed

2.5. Safety Checklist

Run through this checklist before starting the game with new mods:

- [] Mods folder exists and is named **mods** (not **mods_off**)
- [] ScriptHookV.dll and dsound.dll in game root
- [] All mod files installed to correct paths
- [] Backups created for any replaced .rpf files

- [] GTA Online not launched with mods active (rename the **mods** folder to **mods_off** before launching Online)

3. Wave 0: Modlist

3.1. Mod Entry Format

Each entry shows:

- **Category:** UI / QoL / Bugfix
- **Version:** Compatible with v1.73
- **Dependencies:** Required tools or mods
- **Install path:** Where files go
- **System Impact:** What the mod changes
- **Installation:** Special steps (if any)

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(Mod entries to be populated. This section lists UI, quality-of-life, and bug-fix mods compatible with GTA V v1.73. No content additions or mechanic overhauls.)

4. Gameplay Guide

4.1. Core Controls

Key	Action
WASD	Movement
Shift	Sprint (on foot) / Accelerate (vehicle)
Space	Jump / Brake
E	Interact / Enter vehicle
F	Enter/exit cover
Q	Take cover
Left click	Shoot
Right click	Aim
R	Reload
Tab	Switch weapon
M	Phone
Z	Character ability (special)

4.2. Making Money (Early Game)

4.2.1. Story Missions

The fastest money early on comes from story missions. Prioritize:

- Franklin's repo jobs (first few missions)
- Michael's early heist setup missions
- Trevor's early jobs

4.2.2. Stock Market

The LCN and BAWSAQ stock markets are tied to specific story missions. Key rule: **always check Lester's assassination missions** — complete the mission, then invest before the target stock moves. This is the single biggest money-maker in the game.

4.2.3. Side Hustles

- **Taxi work** (Franklin): Easy early cash, unlocks taxi boost
- **Tow truck** (Franklin): Available after certain missions
- **The Epsilon Program** (Michael): Tedious but lucrative
- **Strangers and Freaks**: Random encounters that pay well and unlock content

4.3. Property Investment

4.3.1. Businesses

Buyable properties unlock passive income:

- **Los Santos Customs** (various locations): Mod shop income
- **Cinema** (Michael): Story-specific
- **Cab Company** (Franklin): Story-specific
- **Smoke on the Water**: Dispensary income

4.3.2. Safehouses

Safehouses serve as save points and vehicle storage. Buy them when you have cash — they appreciate in value... in a sense.

4.4. Combat Tips

- **Headshots** are king. Take time to aim.
- **Cover** is your best friend. Don't run into open areas.
- **Use character abilities**: Franklin's bullet-time driving, Michael's slow-mo shooting, Trevor's rage mode.
- **Body armor** is available at Ammu-Nation. Buy it before heist missions.
- **Switch weapons** strategically — use SMGs indoors, rifles at range.

4.5. Vehicle Tips

- **Sell stolen cars** at Los Santos Customs (one per in-game day)
- **Upgrade the turbo and transmission** first — best performance per dollar
- **Keep a fast car and a tough car** — speed for missions, armor for chaos
- **Use Franklin's special** for tight driving sections
- **Motorcycles** weave through traffic faster than cars

Wave 1: Untold Stories

5. Untold Stories

5.1. The Premise

The story missions are done. The big scores are history. But Los Santos is deeper than the main plot reveals — hidden locations, underground economies, new territories, and entire game systems the vanilla world never shows you.

You know the city. Now discover what it hides.

5.2. What Changes

This wave introduces mods that expand the world:

- **New mechanics:** Economy systems, gang warfare, realistic needs
- **New content:** Custom missions, map extensions, vehicles, weapons
- **Graphics overhauls:** Visuals that push the RAGE engine to its limits

5.3. Requirements

Before starting Wave 1:

- Complete the main story in Wave 0
- Familiarity with OpenIV mod management
- Understanding of ScriptHookV and ASI mods
- Strong PC recommended (graphics mods are demanding)

6. Migrating from Wave 0

6.1. Backup Your Saves

Wave 1 uses many of the same save files as Wave 0, but mods can corrupt saves. Backup your save folder before installing new mods:

Documents\Rockstar Games\GTA V\Profiles\<your-profile-id>\

6.2. Removing Wave 0 Mods

Some Wave 0 QoL mods may conflict with Wave 1 mechanics mods. When in doubt:

1. Clear the /mods/ folder
2. Reinstall only Wave 1 mods
3. Keep ScriptHookV and OpenIV — they're shared

6.3. New Dependencies

Wave 1 mods often require additional frameworks:

Framework	Purpose
ScriptHookVDotNet	.NET-based mods
NativeUI	Custom menu interfaces
LemonUI	Alternative UI framework
MapEditor	Map/content editing

6.4. Gameconfig.xml

Many graphics and content mods require a custom **Gameconfig.xml** to increase memory limits:

1. Download a v1.73-compatible Gameconfig.xml
2. Install to: /mods/update/update.rpf/common/data/gameconfig.xml
3. Without this, the game crashes when loading heavy mods

7. Wave 1: Graphics Mods

7.1. Mod Entry Format

- **Category:** Graphics
- **Version:** Compatible with v1.73
- **Dependencies:** Required tools or mods
- **Install path:** Where files go
- **System Impact:** Visual changes to environment, lighting, textures
- **Installation:** Special steps

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(Mod entries to be populated.)

8. Wave 1: Content Mods

(Mod entries to be populated — new missions, map extensions, vehicles, weapons.)

9. Wave 1: Mechanics Mods

(Mod entries to be populated — economy, realism, gang systems, gameplay overhauls.)

10. Wave 1: Adult Mods

Note: Adult/nude mods listed here are for users 18+. Each mod requires explicit approval before inclusion in the final PDF.

(Mod entries to be populated — pending per-mod user approval.)

11. Advanced Strategy Guide

11.1. Optimizing for Modded Gameplay

Heavy mods require tweaking to maintain stable FPS:

11.1.1. Memory and Performance

- Install **HeapAdjuster** or **HeapLimitAdjuster** for memory limit increases
- Use **Gameconfig.xml** tuned to your RAM (8GB/16GB/32GB variants exist)
- Set **-GPUCount** and **-availablevidmem** launch parameters in Steam/RGL
- Disable VSync in-game, cap FPS via GPU driver

11.1.2. Load Order

ASI mods load alphabetically from the root folder. If two ASI mods conflict:

1. Rename one to load later (e.g., **zzz_myMod.asi** loads last)
2. Check each mod's documentation for recommended load position

11.1.3. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely Fix
Crash on startup	Outdated ScriptHookV or missing Gameconfig.xml
Crash on loading save	Corrupted save or missing mod dependency
Textures not loading	Packfile limit reached — use HeapAdjuster
Infinite loading screen	Conflicting .rpf mods — check mods folder
FPS drops	Too many 4K textures — reduce texture quality

11.2. Hidden Content Routes

With content mods installed, explore:

- (To be documented with specific mod content)